



A HOUSING development in the Inland Empire, where enrollment in California’s FAIR Plan is soaring. ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

NEWSOM SIGNS BILLS TO PROTECT VOTING

New laws aim to boost security as Trump tries to exert control over the midterms.

By NICOLE NIXON

SACRAMENTO — Gov. Gavin Newsom on Saturday signed legislation to increase security for the state’s voting systems and protect Californians’ ability to cast ballots in an effort to guard against potential interference in the Nov. 3 election, including by the Trump administration.

Newsom pointed to the Trump administration’s recent effort to restrict mail-in voting through the U.S. Postal Service, which was struck down by the U.S. Supreme Court, and the presence of federal monitors at California polls last year as evidence that Trump “will continue his efforts to interfere with the November election.”

“Donald Trump won’t stop until he can exert dictatorial control over your free vote and disenfranchise millions of people this November. California will stop him at every opportunity,” Newsom said in a statement. “We have no bigger task than fighting to protect the right to vote from interference and meddling — the future of democracy is on the line. These bills today build upon the wall California has built [See Voting, A9]

Voting groups see funding shortfall

Civic engagement activists fear that cuts could lead to lower midterm turnout. **NATION, A10**

Paramount-Warner Bros. merger talks advance

By MEG JAMES

After a bitter standoff, Paramount Skydance and California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta have made progress in settlement talks that could push Hollywood’s massive merger over the finish line, according to people familiar with the matter.

The two sides have quietly been negotiating a truce to end the antitrust lawsuit brought by Bonta and 11

Homebuyers stranded in insurance deserts

With big carriers refusing to cover properties at low risk of fire, many Californians are in a bind

By Paige St. John

Last spring, tech worker Alex Hwang and his wife decided to trade their small house in the pricey San Francisco Bay Area for a big backyard and a new six-bedroom house in Pulte’s Cimarron Ridge development in the Inland Empire, the epicenter of the state’s push to build affordable housing communities.

The couple was in the midst of buying the new \$700,000 house in June, when a complication arose. Pulte normally provides an insurance policy as part of the sale package. Hwang’s real estate agent said getting coverage in the development had never been a problem. The project was on the side of a scrubby hill that looked nothing like the steep timber and chaparral where California’s destructive fires burn and the insurance market has fled.

But as the closing date drew near, the builder told Hwang that its agents could not locate a comprehensive home policy in the standard, regulated insurance market. What it did find for Hwang excluded the fire coverage most lenders re-

quire.

Hwang’s only options were to buy partial protection from the insurer of last resort known as the FAIR Plan, which covers only fire, and pay again for a second policy to cover everything else. Or Hwang could venture into the more flexible surplus lines market, made up of largely out-of-state carriers that specialize in high-risk insurance sold without price controls or state backing. He hadn’t known that such a secondary unregulated market even existed.

With the closing date pressing in, Hwang opted to buy an insurance policy from a surplus line carrier, but it had a hitch. To bring down the cost, the policy contained a clause that, if there was a fire, Hwang would be required to take on \$25,000 in losses out of his own pocket — five times higher than the standard deductible.

“I hate the \$25,000, but I didn’t really have a whole lot of choice,” Hwang said. “None of the big-name insurance compa-

Whether it’s a brush fire, a mass shooting, a car chase or the aftermath of a major storm, viewers in Los Angeles are used to getting the news from above.

Television news helicopter coverage has become one of the most important elements of any local newscast, with the high-flying helicopters roaring overhead a common fixture of breaking news scenes.

These images are so ubiquitous, it may have been easy to take them for granted, until Tuesday, when an NBC4 helicopter carrying reporter Eliana Moreno and pilot George Marciniw crashed while covering breaking news in Chatsworth. Both died, along with a bystander on the ground.

The tragedy has prompted soul-searching in the world of TV news helicopter pilots and focused attention on safety issues.

Pilots describe a high-stakes race in the skies of [See Helicopter, A8]

News pilots balance rivalry, rapport, risk

NBC4 helicopter crash prompts reflection in world of L.A. crews

By SALVADOR HERNANDEZ



FLOWERS at a makeshift memorial for Eliana Moreno and George Marciniw at a Pacoima airport. GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

GOP candidates run with and without Trump

California Republicans keep distance from his unpopular policies as he hits campaign trail.

By ANA CEBALLOS AND JUSTINE MCDANIEL

WASHINGTON — As President Trump tells supporters to vote in November as if he were on the ballot, California Republicans in tight congressional races are sending a different message to voters.

The four California Republicans running in the state’s most competitive U.S. House races, plus a fifth opposing a fellow Republican in a close contest, are appearing to keep some distance from Trump as they campaign ahead of the Nov. 3 election.

They all skipped the president’s midterm convention in Dallas this month. Two candidates in tough races removed references to Trump on their campaign websites. And most are favoring a heavy focus on local and state issues

in their campaigns — a contrast to Trump’s approach, driven home in Dallas, of casting the election as a loyalty exercise.

“You’ve got to do me the biggest favor you’ve ever done me. You’ve got to do this for me, you have to pretend I am on the ticket,” Trump told a crowd at the GOP midterm convention. “Pretend I am on the ticket because this is going to turn out to be one of the most important elections.”

The dynamic within the GOP reflects several competing factors: the need to attract new voters in districts made more purple by California’s redistricting; the hope that Trump can rally the base while candidates focus on swing voters; and the fear among Republicans that the president’s flagging approval ratings could cost them crucial seats in the midterms.

“There is a bit of jujitsu to it,” said Rob Stutzman, a longtime California Republican consultant. “These candidates are hoping that Trump motivates these voters to vote ... [while they] fo-

[See Midterms, A8]

More bachelor’s degrees coming to community colleges

By JAWEED KALEEM

California community colleges will be able to offer bachelor’s degrees that duplicate programs at California State University and University of California schools, clearing the way for the biggest change in decades to degree-granting authority at the state’s public university systems, under legislation approved Friday by Gov. Gavin Newsom.

The pair of bills scraps the state’s ban on community colleges offering any bachelor’s degree already available at CSU or UC, and replaces it with a system built around regional workforce needs and a district college’s performance. They cleared the legislature earlier this month after CSU and UC

withdrew objections.

Newsom signed the bills without comment. The laws will take effect Jan. 1, 2028.

Chancellor Sonya Christian, who leads the community college system, had come out against the two related bills in the final days of the session. She said the versions lawmakers passed — and Newsom has approved — could create “more barriers” than currently exist for community colleges moving to provide new degree programs.

Christian explained her position in an Aug. 29 letter telling the author of SB 960, Sen. Christopher Cabaldon (D-West Sacramento), that last-minute amendments moved the measure away from what community colleges had originally backed.

[See Colleges, A11]



GRAEME SLOAN Getty Images

REPORTERS TURNED AWAY

Journalists from CNN, MS NOW and Politico were denied White House access a day after President Trump issued a ban. **NATION, A6**

Bass and Raman make their case

Candidates talk about their accomplishments and missteps as they vie for the L.A. mayor’s office. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 82/67. **B7**

Business **A12**
Opinion Voices **A18**

Deal is reached over Greenland

Pact expands security role for U.S. The island will remain a Danish territory. **WORLD, A3**

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